

Out with the old, in with the new

Three new entry level DSLRs have been launched by Sony to replace their existing range. The A230 replaces the A200, A330 replaces the A300 and the A380 replaces the A350



The Wireless Gigabit Alliance might speed up Wi-Fi to gigabits speeds using the 60 GHz band. This Wi-Fi might not be able to pass through walls

Bazaar

Samsung R610

Don't forget your reds, and bring on the gloss

Contact

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Price: Rs. 62,339

Specifications

CPU: Core 2 Duo P7350 2 GHz

Chipset: Intel PM45 + ICH9M,

Memory: 3 GB DDR2

Display: 1366 x 768, 16:9 glossy

Graphics: NVIDIA GeForce Go

9200M GS, 512MB GDDR2

HDD: 320GB (5,400 rpm S-ATA)

RATINGS

Features7.5

Performance8

Build Quality7.5

Value for money7.5

Overall7.5

This laptop has a red border styling that is found in Samsung's T-series LCD monitors and TVs. This border protrudes slightly and allows you to see the indicators for charging and Wi-Fi, even with the lid closed.

Other than the usual ports available on most laptops, this one also comes with an HDMI-out. When a disc is loaded into the optical drive, we noticed some vibration on the palm rest, but not too much.

Under the lid, one of the first things you will notice is the number pad next to the standard QWERTY keyboard. The inclusion of the number pad could have been done better though, because the Delete key is now all the way over on the top left, and the arrow keys are shifted down,

causing you to keep hitting up when you want to hit down. Key feedback is good, and the spacing ideal.

The display is good, and there was minimal banding when viewing some HD clips. The screen offers some terrible viewing angles, and is too glossy to boot. The speakers aren't loud, and are actually quite terrible.

The performance scores, however, more than make up for all this. With 3D Mark 05, 06 and PC Mark 05 the scores obtained were average, but in *Doom 3* and *FarCry*, at 1024 x 768 and medium settings, we got fps scores slightly above 40, which is really good for a laptop. With CineBench R10, the CPU got a score of 4172. The R610 took 99.5 seconds



to convert a 100 MB .vob file using the DivX Converter. It took 265.3 seconds to transfer 4 GB of sequential data and 325.8 seconds to transfer 4 GB of assorted data. This laptop is able to play 1080p with ease, but the battery only lasts 1 hour and 27 minutes.

Priced at Rs. 62,339, this laptop will be good value for money and we recommend this to anybody who is on a budget of upto Rs. 65,000.

ZOTAC GeForce GTS 250 AMP!

An expensive proposition

The GTS 250 graphic cards are the rebadged versions of the 9800 GTX+ and the variants that come with 512 MB of memory are basically the same as the 9800 GTX+ cards. The difference in power and PCB design comes only with the 1 GB version of the GTS 250. Other than that, the PCB of the GTS 250 is an inch shorter than that of the 9800 GTX+, but this design is not followed by all manufacturers and the one we have from ZOTAC is of the longer kind.

This card is the 1 GB version, and ZOTAC has used the reference cooling solution from NVIDIA

which takes up two slots. The game *XIII Century: Death or Glory* and 3D Mark Vantage have been bundled along with this card.

This AMP! edition card comes with a core clock of 750 MHz (standard, 738 MHz), Shader Clock 1890 MHz (standard, 1836 MHz) and memory clock of 2300 MHz (standard, 2200 MHz). The number of shaders have not changed and remain at 128. The length of this card remains the same and so has the cooling solution, but what's changed here is that instead of two 6-pin connectors there is a single 8-pin connector.

Performance of this card was tested in Windows Vista using an Intel QX9650 3.0 GHz and 4 GB of DDR2 memory at 1066 MHz. The fps results that were obtained with this card were on the higher side with all the benchmarks at resolutions of 1600 x 1200 and 1920 x 1200 with 4x AA and 4x AF. 3D Mark Vantage also gave us a GPU score of 6847.

The GeForce GTS 250 could be considered either the highest card of the mid-ranged graphics cards or even the lowest of the high-end cards as this falls under the GT-200 series. Overall, the ZOTAC AMP! version of this card is priced at Rs. 10,500 which is where the 9800 GTX+ cards used to be. But with the recent price drop of graphics cards, if you are willing to spend Rs. 14,000, we would suggest you get the GTX 260 which would devour this card whole.

Contact

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Web site: www.zotac.com

Price: Rs. 10,500

Specifications

Core Clock: 750 MHz

Shader Clock: 1890 MHz

Memory Clock: 2300 MHz

Memory Size: 1 GB GDDR3

Memory Interface: 256-bit

RATINGS

Features7

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